

INFORMATIONAL INTERVIEWS

WHAT IS AN INFORMATIONAL INTERVIEW?

A conversation with an Ensign College alumni or professional working in a field, industry, or position you want to know more about. It can be done in-person, video call, or phone, depending on what works best for the person.

WHY CONDUCT INFORMATIONAL INTERVIEWS

Gain Knowledge

- Get career-specific advice
- Access privileged knowledge

Build a Network

- Get tailored career support
- Get the inside scoop

Improve Job Interview

Build confidence talking to employers in a non-stress setting

Lead to Job Prospects

Find opportunities that are not posted yet

SEE ENSIGN CONNECT ROADMAPS 1 & 4 FOR MORE SPECIFIC DETAILS ON HOW TO SUCCEED

WHERE TO START

STEP 1

- Create an Employer list
- Use LinkedIn or Ensign Connect to learn if Ensign alumni work there
- Start connecting with alumni or professionals on LinkedIn or Ensign Connect

STEP 2

- Ask connections for an informational interview
- Prepare for the informational interview
- Conduct the informational interview
- Follow-up after the informational interview

STEP 3

- Complete Roadmap 3 to Improve your LinkedIn profile
- Keep track of all informational interviews and what was discussed for future reference
- For more worksheets to track your contacts see Roadmap 1

FOR MORE INFORMATION

Phone: 801-524-1925

Email: careerservices@ensign.edu

Schedule an appointment with us



ASKING QUESTIONS

Are you uncertain about what questions to ask during and informational interview? Flip over to the back of this page for a list of insightful questions.



INFORMATIONAL INTERVIEWS QUESTIONS

- Why did you decide to work in this industry?
- What steps should someone take to prepare for a role like yours?
- What new skills have you developed as a professional since taking this role?
- Was your undergraduate major relevant to your current position?
- Which certifications are required or can help set you apart in this role?
- What is it like to work for (or run) your company?
- What kinds of decisions do you make in your role?
- Can you describe the company culture?
- What is your favorite thing about your job?
- What is your least favorite thing about your job?
- What skills do I need to develop now to be ready for an internship or position at your company?
- Are there any important projects you are currently working on?
- Do you have a mentor? If so, how have they helped you in your career?
- How many hours do you typically work during the day? week?
- What surprised you the most about your position and industry?
- Can you tell me what a typical day in your job looks like?
- Can you tell me what led to you obtaining your current position?
- Are you able to establish a work/life balance in your field?
- Can you tell me about the most difficult or frequent challenges you face in this role?
- If you weren't in this position, what others would you be interested in pursuing?
- What is the entry-level salary for someone going into this field?
- I've done some research on entry-level salaries in this industry. Are these figures accurate?
- Where do you think you will be in five years? 10 years?
- What trends do you see for this industry in the next three-five years?
- What skills or talents are most essential in this career?
- How do people typically find out about jobs in your line of work?
- Are there any other questions I should be asking you?
- Could you refer me to anyone else who could share knowledge about this job/industry?
- Can we stay in touch?

Practice

As you practice and refine your approach, you will discover which questions give you the best information for your career.

Now go try it for yourself!